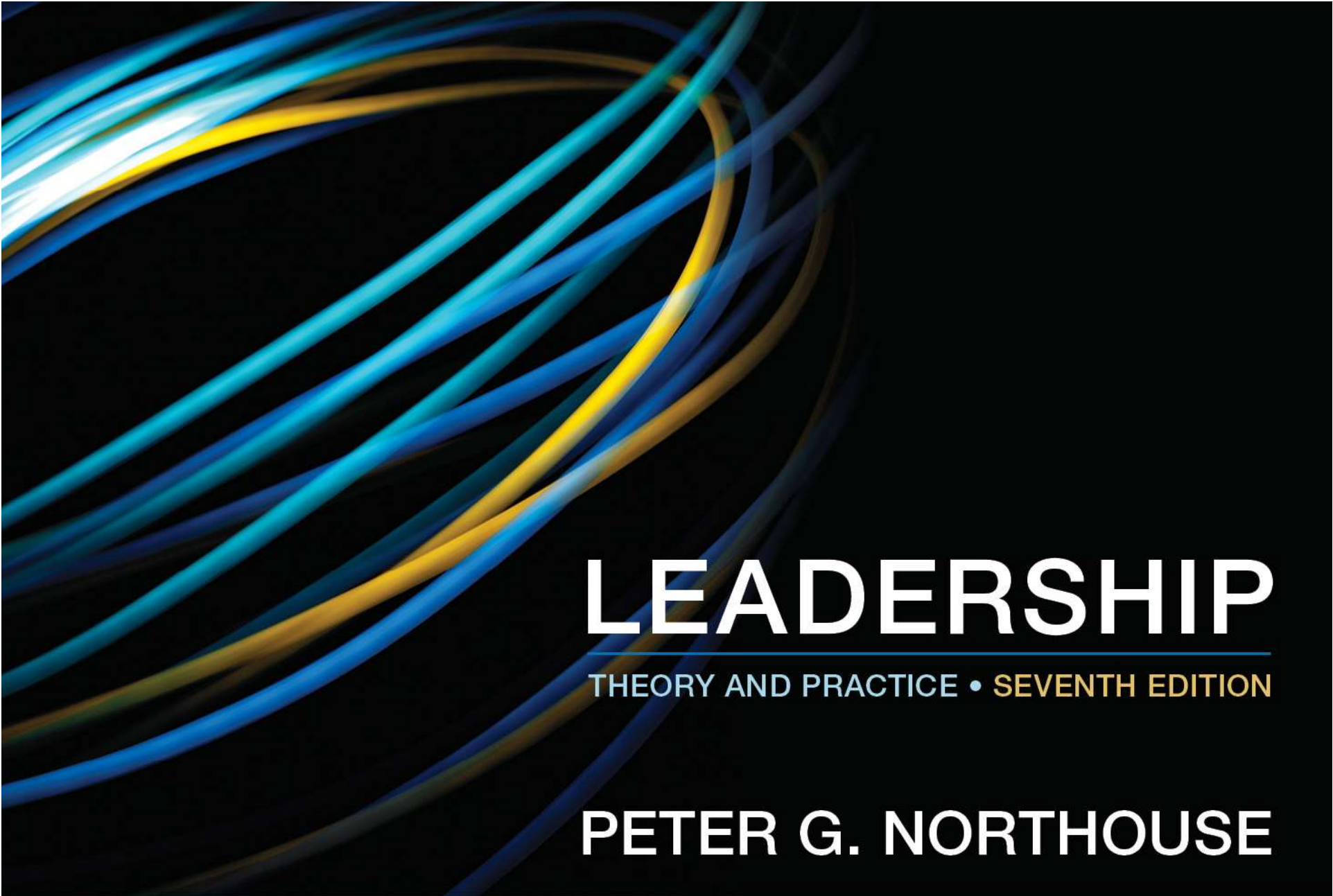




# LEADERSHIP

THEORY AND PRACTICE • SEVENTH EDITION

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Chapter 2: Trait Approach

## ***Overview***

- ✦ Great Person Theories
- ✦ Historical Shifts in Trait Perspective
- ✦ What Traits Differentiate Leaders From Nonleaders?
- ✦ How Does the Trait Approach Work?

## ***Great Person Theories***

***Trait Approach:*** one of the first systematic attempts to study leadership

- ✦ **“Great Man” Theories (early 1900s)**
  - ◆ Focused on identifying innate qualities and characteristics possessed by great social, political, & military leaders

## Historical Shifts in Trait Perspective

**Table 2.1** Studies of Leadership Traits and Characteristics

| Stogdill (1948) | Mann (1959)  | Stogdill (1974) | Lord, DeVader, and Alliger (1986) | Kirkpatrick and Locke (1991) | Zaccaro, Kemp, and Bader (2004) |
|-----------------|--------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| intelligence    | intelligence | achievement     | intelligence                      | drive                        | cognitive abilities             |
| alertness       | masculinity  | persistence     | masculinity                       | motivation                   | extraversion                    |
| insight         | adjustment   | insight         | dominance                         | integrity                    | conscientiousness               |
| responsibility  | dominance    | initiative      |                                   | confidence                   | emotional stability             |
| initiative      | extraversion | self-confidence |                                   | cognitive                    | openness                        |
| persistence     | conservatism | responsibility  |                                   | ability                      | agreeableness                   |
| self-confidence |              | cooperativeness |                                   | task                         | motivation                      |
| sociability     |              | tolerance       |                                   | knowledge                    | social intelligence             |
|                 |              | influence       |                                   |                              | self-monitoring                 |
|                 |              | sociability     |                                   |                              | emotional intelligence          |
|                 |              |                 |                                   |                              | problem solving                 |

SOURCES: Adapted from "The Bases of Social Power," by J. R. P. French, Jr., and B. Raven, 1962, in D. Cartwright (Ed.), *Group Dynamics: Research and Theory* (pp. 259–269), New York: Harper and Row; Zaccaro, Kemp, & Bader (2004).

## ***Major Leadership Traits***

Traits to possess or cultivate if one seeks to be perceived by others as a leader:

- ✦ **Intelligence** – Verbal, perceptual, and reasoning capabilities. Ex. Steve Jobs
- ✦ **Self-Confidence** – Certainty about one's competencies and skills. Ex. Steve Jobs
- ✦ **Determination** – Desire to get the job done (i.e., initiative, persistence, drive). Ex. Dr. Paul Farmer

## ***Major Leadership Traits***

Traits to possess or cultivate if one seeks to be perceived by others as a leader:

- ✦ **Integrity** – The quality of honesty and trustworthiness. Ex. Character Counts! program
- ✦ **Sociability** – Leader's inclination to seek out pleasant social relationships. Ex. Michael Hughes, university president

## ***5-Factor Personality Model & Leadership***

**Table 2.3** Big Five Personality Factors

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|                          |                                                                              |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Neuroticism</b>       | The tendency to be depressed, anxious, insecure, vulnerable, and hostile     |
| <b>Extraversion</b>      | The tendency to be sociable and assertive and to have positive energy        |
| <b>Openness</b>          | The tendency to be informed, creative, insightful, and curious               |
| <b>Agreeableness</b>     | The tendency to be accepting, conforming, trusting, and nurturing            |
| <b>Conscientiousness</b> | The tendency to be thorough, organized, controlled, dependable, and decisive |

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# ***5-Factor Personality Model & Leadership***

*Big Five & Leadership Study Using Meta-Analysis  
(Judge et al., 2002)*

**Results** – a strong relationship between personality traits and leadership

- ✦ ***Extraversion*** – factor most strongly associated with leadership
  - ◆ Most important trait of effective leaders
- ✦ ***Conscientiousness*** – second most related factor
- ✦ ***Openness*** – next most related
- ✦ ***Low Neuroticism***
- ✦ ***Agreeableness*** – only weakly related to leadership

# ***Emotional Intelligence & Leadership***

## **Definition**

### **Ability to perceive and:**

- ✦ apply emotions to life's tasks
- ✦ reason/understand emotions
- ✦ express emotions
- ✦ use emotions to facilitate thinking
- ✦ manage emotions within oneself and relationships

## **Underlying Premise**

- ✦ people who are more sensitive to their emotions & their impact on others will be more effective leaders

## ***Different Ways to Measure EQ***

- ✦ **MSCEIT:** EQ as a set of mental abilities
  - ✦ to perceive, facilitate, understand, and manage emotion
- ✦ **Goleman (1995, 1998):** EQ as a set of personal and social competencies
  - ✦ self-awareness, confidence, self-regulation, conscientiousness, and motivation
- ✦ **Shankman & Allen (2002):** EQ as awareness of three aspects of leadership
  - ✦ context, self, and others

## ***How Does the Trait Approach Work?***

- ✦ Focus of Trait Approach
- ✦ Strengths
- ✦ Criticisms
- ✦ Application

## ***Focus of Trait Approach***

### **Leader**

- ✦ Focuses ***exclusively*** on leader
  - ◆ What traits leaders exhibit
  - ◆ Who has these traits

### **Personality Assessments**

- ✦ Organizations use personality assessments to find “right” people
  - ◆ ***Assumption*** - will increase organizational effectiveness
  - ◆ Specify characteristics/traits for specific positions
    - Personality assessment measures for “fit”
    - Instruments: LTQ, Myers-Briggs

## ***Strengths***

- ✧ Intuitively ***appealing***
  - ◆ Perception that leaders are different in that they possess special traits
  - ◆ People “need” to view leaders as gifted
- ✧ ***Credibility*** due to a century of research support
- ✧ Highlights ***leadership component*** in the leadership process
  - ◆ Deeper level understanding of how leader/personality is related to leadership process
- ✧ Provides ***benchmarks*** for what to look for in a leader

## ***Criticisms***

- ✦ Fails to ***delimit*** a definitive list of leadership traits
  - ◆ Endless lists have emerged
- ✦ Doesn't take into account ***situational effects***
  - ◆ Leaders in one situation may not be leaders in another situation
- ✦ List of most important leadership traits is ***highly subjective***
  - ◆ Much subjective experience & observations serve as basis for identified leadership traits
- ✦ Research fails to look at traits in relationship to leadership ***outcomes***
- ✦ Not useful for ***training & development***

## ***Application***

- ✦ Provides direction as to which traits are good to have if one aspires to a leadership position
- ✦ Through various tests and questionnaires, individuals can determine whether they have the select leadership traits and can pinpoint their strengths and weaknesses
- ✦ Can be used by managers to assess where they stand within their organization and what is needed to strengthen their position

### **Leadership Traits**

- **Intelligence**
- **Self-Confidence**
- **Determination**
- **Integrity**
- **Sociability**